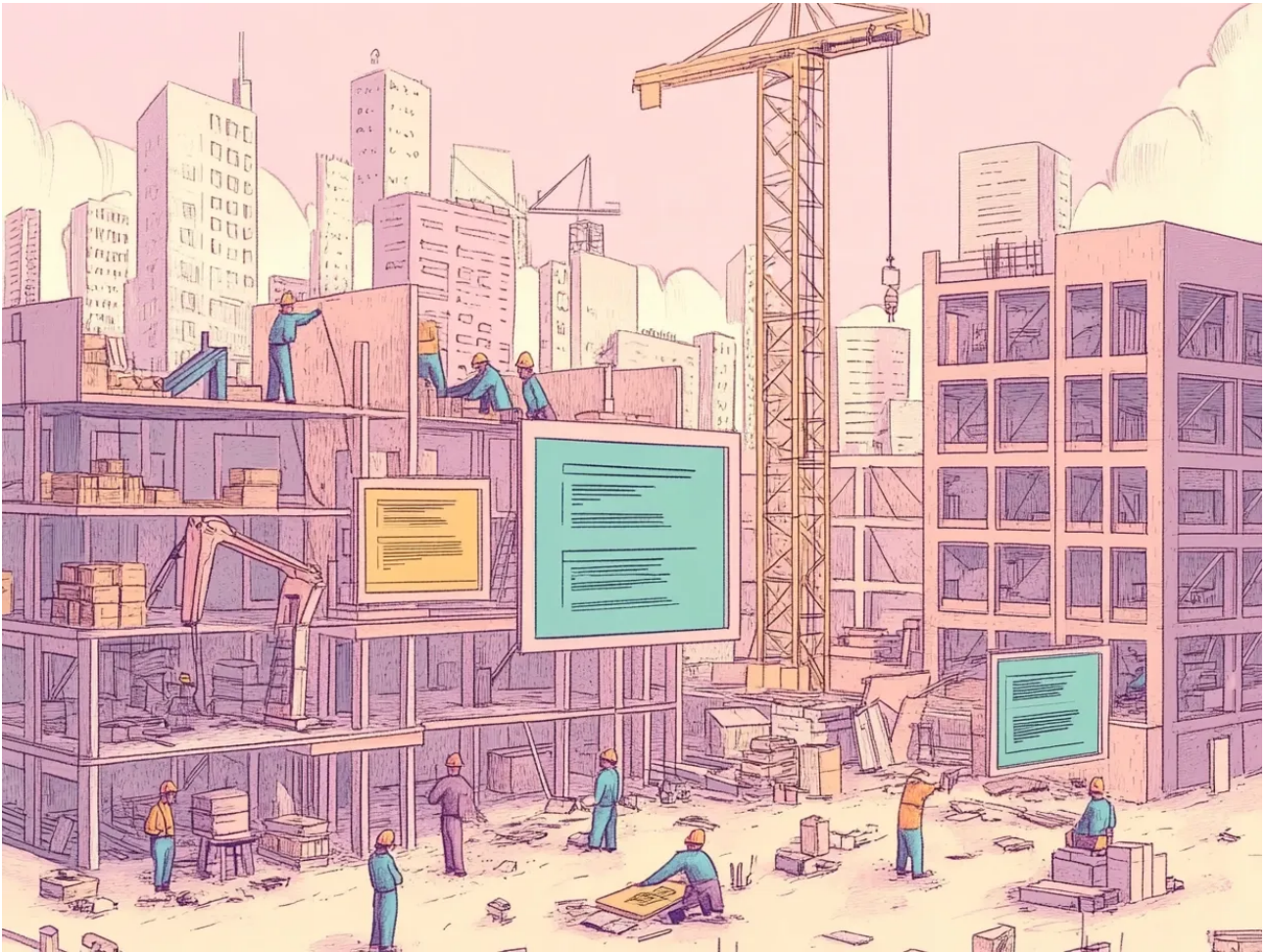




What to Ask Your Website Company

Questions & Checklist Workbook

A free companion to the book by Dave Cross

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook collects all of the questions from *What to Ask Your Website Company* in one place, so you can use it as a practical reference when meeting with web developers or agencies — or simply to clarify your own thinking before the conversation begins.

Each chapter has two sets of questions:

- **Questions to Ask Yourself** — clarify what you need before you talk to anyone. Space is provided after each question for your notes.
- **Questions to Ask Your Website Company** — probe their competence, honesty, and fit. Use the writing lines to jot down their answers.

The final section is a complete checklist to tick off before signing any contract.

Get the full book at davecross.co.uk/whattoask

Chapter 1: Defining Your Website Goals

Questions to Ask Yourself

- What is the primary purpose of my website? (Lead generation, sales, information, etc.)

- What action do I want visitors to take? (Fill out a contact form, buy something, call me, etc.)

- Who is my target audience? (Age, location, interests, online behaviour.)

- How will I measure success? (More enquiries, increased sales, better brand recognition.)

- What content do I need? (Do I already have text and images, or do I need help creating them?)

Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- How will you design the site to help achieve my goals?

- What features do you recommend based on my business type?

- Can you provide examples of websites you've built for similar businesses?

- How will the website encourage visitors to take action?

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- Can you help with content, or do I need to provide everything myself?
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Chapter 2: Choosing the Right Platform

Questions to Ask Yourself

- Will I need to update the website myself? If so, you'll want something user-friendly.
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-
- Do I need to sell products online? If yes, e-commerce platforms like Shopify might be best.
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-
- What's my budget for setup and ongoing costs? Some platforms have monthly fees, others require hosting and maintenance.
-
-
- Will I need advanced features in the future? If your business will grow, choose a scalable platform.
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-
- How important is SEO? Some platforms (like WordPress) are better for search engine rankings than others.
-
-

Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- Which platform do you recommend for my business, and why?
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-

-
- Will I be able to update the website myself? If so, how?

- What are the ongoing costs for hosting, maintenance, or subscriptions?

- Can I move my website to another provider in the future if needed?

- What are the pros and cons of the platform you're suggesting?

Chapter 3: SEO & Performance

Questions to Ask Yourself

- Who are my target customers, and what will they search for?

- Is my business local, national, or international? Local businesses need different SEO strategies.

- Do I plan to write blog posts or update content regularly? Fresh content helps with SEO.

- How important is speed and mobile-friendliness to my audience?

Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- How will you optimise my site for search engines?

- Will my site be mobile-friendly and fast?

- What tools do you use to track website traffic and SEO performance?

- Will you set up basic SEO features like page titles and descriptions?

- Do you offer ongoing SEO support or advice?

Chapter 4: Security & Ongoing Maintenance

Questions to Ask Yourself

- Who will be responsible for keeping my website updated?

- What happens if my website gets hacked or goes offline?

- Do I need to update my own content, or will someone do it for me?

- How important is uptime and security for my business?

Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- Will my website have an SSL certificate, and is it included in the cost?
- How often do you update the website software, plugins, and security settings?
- Will my website have automatic backups? Where are they stored?
- What security measures do you implement to prevent hacking?
- Do you offer ongoing maintenance services, and how much do they cost?

Chapter 5: Content & User Experience

Questions to Ask Yourself

- What key information must be on my website? (Services, pricing, testimonials, etc.)
- What action do I want visitors to take?
- Do I have high-quality images and written content, or do I need help creating them?

-
-
- Does my target audience browse on mobile, desktop, or both?
-
-

Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- Will you help with content, or do I need to provide everything myself?
-

- How will you ensure the site is easy to navigate?
-

- Will the website be fully mobile-friendly?
-

- Can you optimise images and pages for fast loading?
-

- How will you make sure the site is accessible to all users?
-
-

Chapter 6: E-commerce & Payment Systems

Questions to Ask Yourself

- What products or services am I selling? (Physical, digital, subscriptions?)
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- Do I need a simple store or a fully customised e-commerce solution?
-

-
-
- Which payment methods do my customers prefer?
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-

- How will I handle shipping, returns, and customer service?
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Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- Which e-commerce platform do you recommend, and why?
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-

- Will my store be secure and PCI compliant?
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-

- How will the checkout process be optimised to maximise sales?
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- Can the system handle VAT and tax calculations automatically?
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- What are the ongoing costs for my e-commerce setup?
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-
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Chapter 7: Integrations & Automation

Questions to Ask Yourself

- What tools do I already use (email marketing, CRM, booking software)?

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- What tasks am I currently doing manually that could be automated?
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- How important is it for my website to collect and organise customer data?
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- Do I need real-time notifications for new leads or bookings?
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-

Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- Can my website integrate with the specific tools I use?
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-

- Will form submissions be automatically stored in my CRM or emailed to me?
-
-

- Can my site automate appointment bookings and payment processing?
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-

- What automation options can you recommend to save me time?
-
-

- Will integrations require ongoing maintenance or extra costs?
-
-

Chapter 8: Pricing & Ownership

Questions to Ask Yourself

- What's my total budget (including ongoing costs)?

- Do I want to manage my own website, or will I need ongoing support?

- Am I comfortable with the platform, or will I rely on a developer for changes?

- What happens if I want to switch providers in the future?

Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- What's included in the quoted price, and what's extra?

- Who owns the domain name and hosting account?

- Will I have full admin access to my website?

- Are there any ongoing costs I need to be aware of?

- Can I move my website to another provider if needed?

Chapter 9: Red Flags & How to Spot a Bad Website Company

Questions to Ask Yourself

- Do I feel comfortable with their level of communication and transparency?

- Have I checked their previous work and reviews?

- Do I fully understand what I'm paying for?

- If I need to move my website elsewhere, can I?

Questions to Ask Your Website Company

- Can I see examples of websites you've built for businesses like mine?

- Who owns the website and domain name once it's built?

- What happens if I need support after launch?

- Are there any hidden fees or ongoing costs?

- How do you handle security and updates?

Final Checklist

Before Hiring a Website Company

1. Business Goals & Strategy

- ☐ I know what I want my website to achieve.
- ☐ I have a clear idea of what pages and features I need.
- ☐ I know how I will measure the success of my website.

2. Choosing the Right Platform

- ☐ I understand the pros and cons of WordPress, Shopify, Wix, or a custom site.
- ☐ I know whether I want to manage the site myself or rely on a developer.
- ☐ I've checked that my website can be moved to another provider if needed.

3. SEO & Performance

- ☐ My website will be mobile-friendly and optimised for search engines.
- ☐ The company will set up Google Analytics and Search Console.
- ☐ My website will load quickly and follow SEO best practices.

4. Security & Ongoing Maintenance

- ☐ My site will have an SSL certificate (HTTPS).
- ☐ The company has a plan for updates, backups, and security.
- ☐ I understand who is responsible for maintaining my site after launch.

5. Content & User Experience

- ☐ My website will be easy to navigate and accessible to all users.
- ☐ Calls to Action (CTAs) will be clear and visible.
- ☐ I have a plan for creating or updating content on my site.

6. E-commerce & Payment Systems

- ☐ My website will use a secure and reliable payment system.
- ☐ Shipping, tax, and order management are all set up correctly.
- ☐ The checkout process is fast and user-friendly.

7. Integrations & Automation

- ☐ My website can connect to my CRM, email marketing, or booking system.
- ☐ I understand how automation can save me time.
- ☐ The website company can set up any essential integrations.

8. Pricing & Ownership

- ☐ I know the full cost of the website, including ongoing fees.
- ☐ I will own my domain name and website after launch.
- ☐ I have full admin access and control over my website.

9. Choosing the Right Website Company

- ☐ They have good reviews and a portfolio of real client work.
- ☐ They communicate clearly and explain things in plain English.
- ☐ There are no hidden fees, long contracts, or vague pricing.
- ☐ They offer support or training for managing the site after launch.

Enjoyed this workbook?

Get the full book — packed with practical advice, real-world examples, and everything you need to make smart decisions about your website.

davecross.co.uk/whattoask

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